Appian Academy



# Build an Application: Step-by-Step #4

## Create the User Experience

The Appian Step-by-Step series consists of 5 modules that accompany the courses in the Appian Developer learning path. Each module contains a set of exercises that correspond to the topics you learned in the preceding courses.

1. Introduction
2. Construct Your Data Fabric
3. Application Actions
4. **Create the User Experience**
5. Interfaces, Reports, and Sites

Complete exercises in order and keep the app and all objects until you are done with the project.

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This exercise was developed for **Appian 26.6**. If Appian Community Edition is on a later Appian version, functionality might be different. Go to academy.appian.com to download the latest exercise.

# Exercise 1: Update User Interfaces - Record List

In this exercise, you will update the **W#ER Equipment** and **W#ER Rental Request** record types by configuring a user-friendly record list. You will learn how to transform raw data into a functional grid by adding document images. By the end of these steps, you will have an interface that allows users to easily identify and access specific equipment records.

## User Stories



As a Support Agent or Support Supervisor, I want to…

- View a list of our equipment inventory, so that I can assist customers with their rental requests.
- View a list of our rental requests, so that I can assist customers with their rental requests.

## Configure the W#ER Equipment Record Type

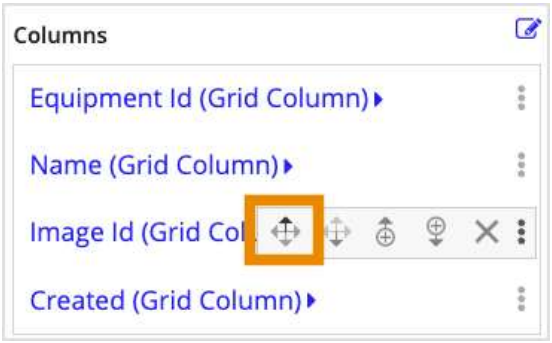
Follow the steps below to configure the **W#ER Equipment** record type.

1. In the **Build** view, select the **W#ER Equipment** record type.
2. In the left navigation menu, go to the **List** page.
3. Click **EDIT LIST**.
4. In the **Grid** configuration pane, click the **Data** tab.
5. In the **Columns** section, to the right of **Modified**, hover your mouse over the 3 vertical dots and click the **X** to remove the field from the list.


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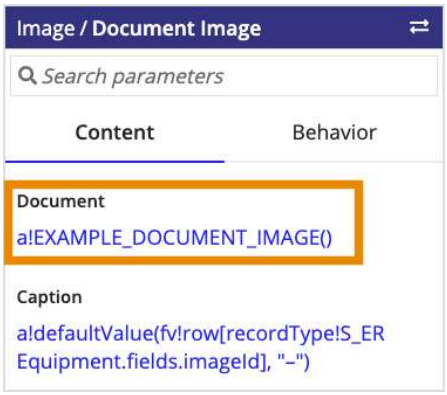

6. Next, for **Image Id**, use the 3 vertical dots and the leftmost arrows to move the column to above **Equipment Id**.




7. Click on **Image Id**.
8. Under **Label**, click on **Image Id**.
9. In the **Label (Text)** dialog, clear the text so the label is blank.
10. Click **OK**.
11. In the **Data** tab, under **Display Value**, click **DISPLAY OPTIONS**.
12. Under **IMAGES**, select **Document Image**.
13. Under **Display Value**, click **Image**.
14. In the **Content** tab, under **Images**, select **Document Image**.


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15. Under **Document**, click **a!EXAMPLE_DOCUMENT_IMAGE**.




16. In the **Document** expression box, enter the following expression:

```
rule!W#ER_GetEquipmentImage(
 imageId: fv!row[recordType!W#ER Equipment.fields.imageId],
 typeId: fv!row[recordType!W#ER Equipment.fields.typeId]
 )
```

This expression rule was created for you to support the completion of this exercise. It ensures that there is consistency across all equipment images, if there is no equipment image available.

17. Click **OK**.
18. Click **OK**.
19. Click **SAVE**.

**Challenge: Configure the W#ER Rental Request record list to display the related equipment image.**

## Exercise 2: Create Summary Views

In this exercise, you will generate record views and configure record titles.


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## User Stories



As a Support Agent or Support Supervisor, I want to…

- View the details about a single piece of equipment so that I can review its details.
- View the details for a single request, so that I can review the request details.
- Access the Update Request related action so that I can quickly support customer booking questions.



As a Support Supervisor, I want to access the Update Equipment related action directly from the Equipment summary view, so that I can quickly perform my admin functions.

## Generate Equipment Summary View

Follow the steps below to generate the summary view for the **W#ER Equipment** record type.

1. In the left navigation menu, go to the **Views** page.
2. Click **GENERATE RECORD VIEW**.
3. In the **Select Record Types** dialog, select **equipment** and **rentalRequest**.

**Optional:** To include the configured rental request record list grid in the **W#ER Equipment** summary view, you should complete the challenge in the previous exercise in the **W#ER Rental Request** record list before generating the summary view.

4. Click **NEXT**.
5. Keep everything as-is.
6. Click **NEXT**.
7. Click **GENERATE**.
8. Click **CLOSE**.
9. Click **SAVE**.


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## Preview the Interface

Under **Views**, under the **Interface** column, you will notice the interface that was created for you: **W#ER_EquipmentSummary**.

1. Using your keyboard, click and hold the **Options key (for Windows)** or **Command key (for Mac)**, and click on **rule!W#ER_EquipmentSummary()**. This shortcut will open the interface and you can see the current layout and configuration.

## Generate Rental Request Summary View

Follow the steps below to generate the summary view for the **W#ER Rental Request** record type.

1. In the **Build** view, open the **W#ER Rental Request** record type.
2. In the left navigation menu, click **Views**.
3. Click **GENERATE RECORD VIEW**.
4. In the **Select Record Types** dialog, select the following:
    - Rental Request
    - customer
    - equipment
    - rentalRequestDocuments
5. Click **NEXT**.
6. Keep everything as-is.
7. Click **NEXT**.
8. Click **GENERATE**.
9. Click **CLOSE**.
10. Click **SAVE**.

Follow the same steps from the previous section to preview the **W#ER_RentalRequestSummary** interface.

## Configure the Record Title

Follow the steps below to configure the record title for the **W#ER Rental Request** record type.


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1. In the **Views** page, under **Header**, scroll down to locate the **Record Title**.
2. Click the radio button for **Expression**.
3. In the expression editor, enter the following expression to create a custom record title:

```
rv!record[recordType!W#ER Rental
Request.relationships.W#ER Equipment.fields.name]
& " - " &
rv!record[recordType!W#ER Rental
Request.relationships.W#ER Customer.fields.firstName]
```

   **Expression Tip:** This expression will generate a record title in the following format: **Equipment Name - Customer First Name**. For Example, **Snowboard - Roger**.

   **Challenge:** Try expanding the expression to include the customer's last name too.

4. Click **SAVE**.

To check out how the **Rental Request** record title looks:

1. Click on the **View Record List**  icon to the right of **W#ER Rental Request**, at the top left of the record type designer.
2. In the **Id** field, click a value to open a rental request.
3. Verify the **Record Title** displays correctly.

## Exercise 3: Configure the Create or Update Equipment Interface

In this exercise, you will modify the **W#ER_CreateOrUpdateEquipment** interface to improve the user experience and ensure data integrity. You will adjust the layout, configure a file upload component for equipment images, and add an expression to capture the equipment status on submit.


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## User Stories



As a Support Supervisor, I want a streamlined and focused interface for creating or updating equipment, so that I only see and interact with the most essential fields.

## Customize the Interface

Follow the steps below to remove unneeded fields from the Create or Update Equipment interface.

1. In the **Build** view, open the **W#ER_CreateOrUpdateEquipment** interface.
2. From the canvas, click on the **Image Id** component.
3. Using the dropdown from the **Integer** tab, select **Delete** to remove the component.



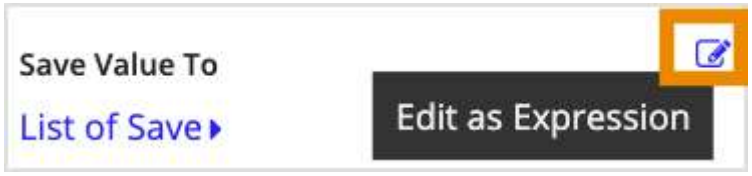

4. Repeat the same step to remove the **Equipment Status** component.
5. Using the **Palette**, under **Inputs**, drag and drop the **File Upload** component below the **Description** paragraph field.
6. Using the **Component Configuration** pane on the right side, under **Content**, rename the **Label** to `Equipment Image`.
7. In the **Data** tab, under **Selected Files**, select **ri!equipment.imageId**. By default, **Save Files To** is also configured to the same field.
8. Under **Target**, select **Document or folder**.
9. In the **Select a constant** text field, enter and select **W#ER_FLD_DOCUMENTS**.

The **W#ER_FLD_DOCUMENTS** constant was already created for you to support the completion of this exercise. It is a constant that points to the **W#ER Artifacts** document folder.

10. In the **Behavior** tab, under **Maximum Selections**, enter `1`.


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11. From the canvas, click the **CREATE** button.
12. In the **Component Configuration** pane, click on the **Data** tab.
13. Next to **Save Value To**, select the **Edit as Expression** icon.




14. Go to line **22**. After the last **a!save** expression, add a comma , after the closing parentheses and enter onto a new line.
15. On the new line (line **23**) , enter the following:

```
a!save(
  target:ri!equipment[W#ER Equipment.equipmentStatusId],
  value: cons!W#ER_INT_EQUIPMENT_STATUS_IN_INVENTORY
)
```

16. Click **OK**.
17. Click **SAVE**.

# Exercise 4: Configure the Create or Update Request Interface

In this exercise, you will continue building the Acme Sport Equipment Rental application by refining the **W#ER_CreateOrUpdateRentalRequest** interface. To ensure a streamlined user experience, you will modify the existing layout by removing unnecessary components and organizing date and customer fields into a more intuitive structure.

## User Stories



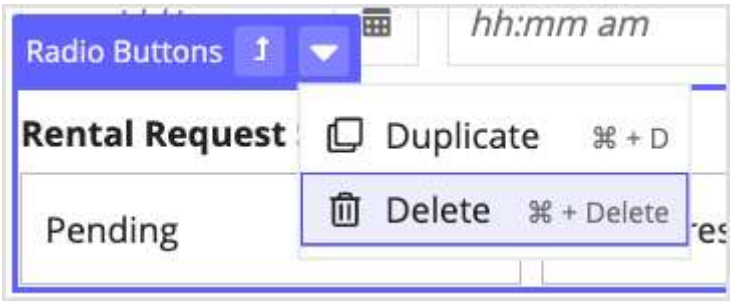
As a Support Agent or Support Supervisor, I want a streamlined and focused interface for creating or updating rental requests, so that I only see and interact with the most essential fields.


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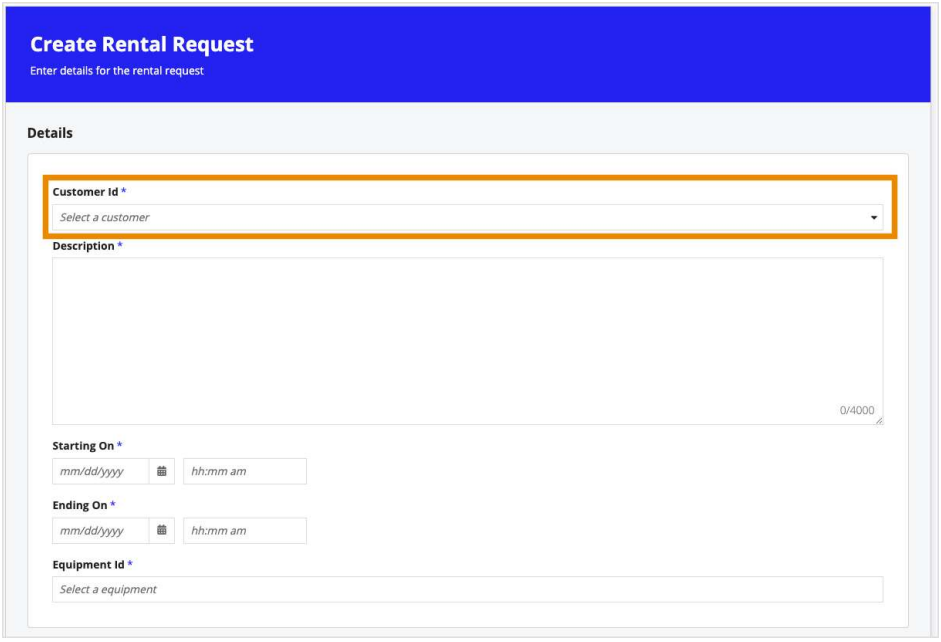
## Customize the Interface

First, you will rearrange the layout of the components.

1. In the **Build** view, open the **W#ER_CreateOrUpdateRentalRequest** interface.
2. From the canvas, click on the **Rental Request Status** component.
3. Using the dropdown from the **Radio Buttons** tab, select **Delete** to remove the component.



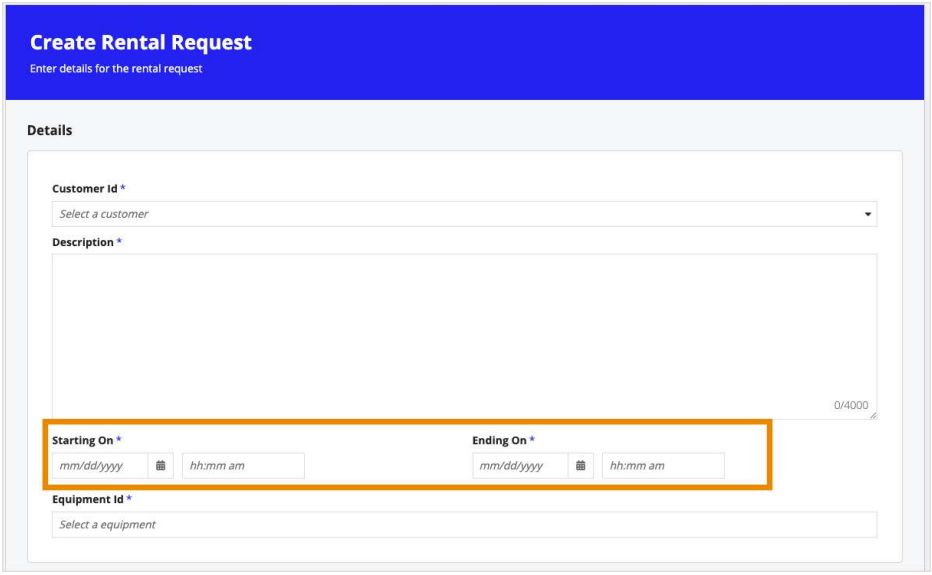

4. Using your mouse, drag the **Customer Id** dropdown component to be above **Description**.
5. Repeat the step for the **Equipment Id** record picker, and place it below the **Customer** dropdown component.




6. Using the **Palette**, under **Layouts**, drag and drop a **COLUMNS** layout under **Description**.


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7. Click on the **trash can symbol** to delete one column from the columns layout so there are only two columns.
8. Drag the **Starting On** component to the left column.
9. Drag the **Ending On** component to the right column.




Next, configure the components.

1. From the canvas, click on the **Customer Id** dropdown component.
2. In the **Component Configuration** pane, under **Label**, click on **Customer Id**.
3. In the expression window, delete the expression and enter `"Customer"`.

   **Tip:** By default, generated interfaces have component labels mapped to their record field display names. This speeds up development by having labels already configured, and promotes interface maintainability if the display names should ever change.
4. Repeat the above steps to update **Equipment Id** to **Equipment**.
5. From the canvas, click on the **Rental Request Documents** Heading component.
6. Double click the label **Rental Request Documents** and rename it to **Rental Agreement**.
7. From the canvas, click the **CREATE** submit button.
8. In the **Component Configuration** pane, click on the **Data** tab.
9. Next to **Save Value To**, select the **Edit as Expression** icon.
10. Under the last **a!save** expression on line **22**, add a comma `,` and enter to a new line.

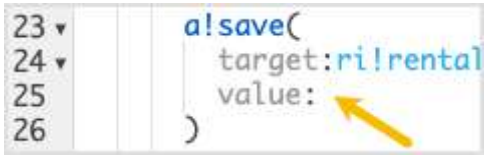

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11. On the new line **23**, enter the following:

```
a!save(
target: ri!rentalRequest[W#ER Rental Request.rentalRequestStatusId],
value:
)
```

**Note:** Because the **value** parameter is undefined, you will have an expression error (red triangle) until you complete the below steps.

12. Using your mouse, place your cursor to the right of **value:**




13. From the toolbar, click on the Create a Constant icon (**π**)



14. In the **Create Constant** dialog, configure the following:
    - **Name**: Enter `W#ER_INT_RENTAL_REQUEST_STATUS_PENDING`
    - **Description**: Enter `The Rental Request Status ID for Pending.`
    - **Type**: Ensure it is set to **Number (Integer)**.
    - **Value**: Enter `1`.
    - **Save In**: Ensure **W#ER Constants** is selected.
    - Keep everything else as-is.
    - Click **CREATE**.

You will notice the constant you just created was automatically added into your **a!save** expression. This can save development time by being able to create constants when you need them, without having to navigate back to **Build** view.

15. Click **OK**.
16. Click **SAVE**.


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# Module Recap

In this module, you updated the **W#ER Equipment** and **W#ER Rental Request** record types to improve the display of information in the record list, and generate summary views.

## Why is this important?

- **Enhanced Visual Identification:** Adding equipment images directly into the grid allows users to identify rental items at a glance, reducing the time spent clicking into individual records.
- **Reduced Cognitive Load:** Removing system-generated fields (like "Modified On") and cleaning up labels creates a focused, professional interface that highlights only the data most relevant to the end user's tasks.
- **Streamline Data Accessibility**: Generating views automatically creates the necessary interfaces and rules, saving development time and ensuring a consistent look and feel across the application.

Up next, Step-by-Step #5! Get excited! You are almost done.


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